stated only in Afzal's statement under Section 313 Criminal Procedure Code. With this citation, therefore, the special court judgement lends credibility to the statement. Furthermore, there are manifest instances of honesty and truthfulness in Afzal's statement 313. For example, Afzal did not shy away from admitting the possibly incriminating fact that he brought Mohammad from Kashmir and that he accompanied Mohammad when the latter purchased a second-hand Ambassador. The Supreme Court judgement recorded that when his lawyer attempted to deny this fact during the trial, Afzal intervened to insist that he had indeed accompanied Mohammad.

Pursuing the relevant paragraph of this statement then, we learn about the circumstances of Afzal's surrender to the BSF in 1993 in detail. Afzal states that he was frequently asked by the STF to work for them; he often paid large sums of money to the STF to escape detention; yet, he was detained as late as in 2000; he was asked to become a special police officer, which is an euphemism for 'police informer'; he met one Tariq in the STF camp; this Tariq was already working for the STF and he wanted Afzal to join the force as well; Afzal was introduced to one Mohammad by Tariq also in the STF camp; Tariq persuaded him to take Mohammad to Delhi from where Mohammad was planning to go abroad.

A number of disturbing consequences follow. First, Afzal was in close touch with the security agencies throughout 1993 to at least 2000. Second, three of the persons allegedly involved in the attack—Tariq, Afzal, Mohammad—the mastermind, the link and the leader of the attack—originated from the STF camp itself. In addition, we now know of a press report from Thane that four terrorists including one 'Hamza'—the same name as one of the terrorists killed in the Parliament attack—had been arrested by the Thane police in November 2000 and handed over to the J & K police for further investigation.[26]

Grave, unanswered questions surround the Parliament attack case even after three judicial pronouncements. Who attacked the Parliament and what was the conspiracy? On what basis did the NDA government take the country close to a nuclear war? What was the role of the State Task Force (J&K) on surrendered militants? What was the role of the special cell of the Delhi police in conducting the case?

It will be a travesty of justice to hang Mohammad Afzal without ascertaining answers to these questions. Given the momentous nature of these